



Figure 1: Adding a figure caption



Figure 2: Generate a figure caption

Selector syntax

In plain English, jQuery is all about ‘select something, do something’. In pseudo-code, that can be written as:

```
$(select_something).doSomething();
```

jQuery gives much flexibility in the selection of elements through traditional tree traversals, direct access to DOM elements, and also selecting a set of objects. jQuery’s power comes from extensive operations that can be performed to manipulate the content and appearance of the elements in the HTML page. This is what makes jQuery useful in most cases—routine actions that take hundreds of lines of code are made into a ready-to-use library.

- *select_something* can be an HTML tag, a class or an id. Some examples are given below:

<code>\$('p')</code>	selecting paragraph elements
<code>\$('myclass')</code>	selecting all elements with class="myclass"
<code>\$('#myid')</code>	selecting all elements with id="myid"

- Next, *doSomething()* can be an operation like *hide()* or *attr(a, v)*. For an extensive list of operations, visit the jQuery home page (see *References*).

Setting up jQuery

You can start using the jQuery library in three ways:

- Copy to local server or machine (use as `<script src="jquery.js"></script>`)
- Refer to *jquery.js* from *jquery.com* (`<script src="http://code.jquery.com/jquery-latest.js"></script>`)
- Refer to *jquery.js* from a CDN hosted by Google (or Microsoft): (`<script src="http://ajax.googleapis.com/ajax/libs/jquery/1.7.2/jquery.min.js"></script>`)

An example

Now let us dive into an example that demonstrates the benefits of jQuery over basic JavaScript. This program will insert Figure number and caption below each picture on the Web page. The author of a web page only needs to insert images and add appropriate text in ‘alt’ attribute of `<img>` HTML tag.

Steps in the program:

1. Identify the figure number.
2. Extract the string from the image ‘alt’ tag, which will be the figure caption.
3. Place the figure caption below every image.

This program can also be extended to generate a ‘Table of Contents’ for a document, which can be inserted at the beginning of the page. Figure 1 contains a heading and two sections. Each section has a paragraph, picture and an empty place-holder for inserting the figure caption. On clicking the button ‘Generate figure caption’, you can see (Figure 2) the captions inserted after each image.

```

1  <!doctype html>
2  <html>
3    <head>
4
5    <style type="text/css">
6      div.caption
7      {
8        border: 2px solid;
9        border-radius: 25px;
10     }
11   </style>
12   <script src="include/jquery.js"></script>
13   <script type="text/javascript">
14     $(document).ready(function() {
```